

# The Gazette Looking back

100 years ago — January 8, 1897

David Ranger, of the Palace Hotel, Ottawa, was tried on Tuesday on the charge of having in his possession a duplicate of the seal used by Walker & Son, distillers, of Walkerville, and also with opening liquor barrels, adulterating the liquor and sealing them up again. The offence is an indictable one and punishable with a heavy sentence.

On Monday evening Bro. S. S. Merick, D.D.G.M., accompanied by Past Grands N. D. McCallum, D. J. Armstrong and Wm. Munroe, and Bro. Greig, of Stella lodge, installed the officers of Alpha Lodge I.O.O.F., Almonte.

Nominations for the vacancies on the council board for the Second Ward take place in the town hall tomorrow (Friday) night. There is a strong desire with some to see Messrs. Drynan and Fay elected, and Mr. Geo. O'Brien is also being pressed to enter the contest.

Mr. Henry A. Twigg, of Pakenham township, lost everything his house contained in the fire that destroyed his house a week or so ago. He puts his loss at close on \$1,000. His friends and neighbors gave him a New Year gift of \$50 to help start him afresh.

50 years ago — January 9, 1947

The organization meeting of the Public Utilities Commission of Almonte was held, Wednesday evening, Jan. 8th.

Present Mayor Alex McDonald, Dr. Metcalfe, and Messrs. Gleason, Black and Houston.

The secretary called for nominations for the chairmanship of the commission for 1947. Mayor Alex McDonald was nominated by Cms. Metcalfe and Black and there being no other nominations the secretary declared him elected and asked Mayor McDonald to take the chair.

Town streets in Almonte have been plowed out from the time of the first snow storm. It is understood Carleton Place had some trouble in this connection and asked the officials here if they could help them. Unfortunately the local plow was too busy to be dispatched to the neighboring municipality.

25 years ago — January 13, 1972

What police and postal officials believe was an act of vandalism has caused considerable damage to the new Almonte Post Office building and will no doubt inconvenience many residents due to the revision of hours that the local box lobby will be open in the future.

Fire that started in the plastic bin below the mail chute in the lobby sometime before eleven o'clock on Saturday night caused extensive smoke damage before it was extinguished by O.P.P. police and firemen.

Reeve John Cochran will be a member of a panel discussion on Municipal Attitudes to Tourism at a Conference on The Municipality and Tourism to be held at the Chateau Laurier in Ottawa January 25 and 26.

The new Ramsay Township Municipal Offices and Garage located on the old Perth Road at the corner of the 8th line, one mile south-west of Almonte, will be officially opened on Friday, January 21st, at 4:30 p.m., followed by a social evening at 8:30, featuring dancing and entertainment, to which the public is invited.

10 years ago — January 14, 1987

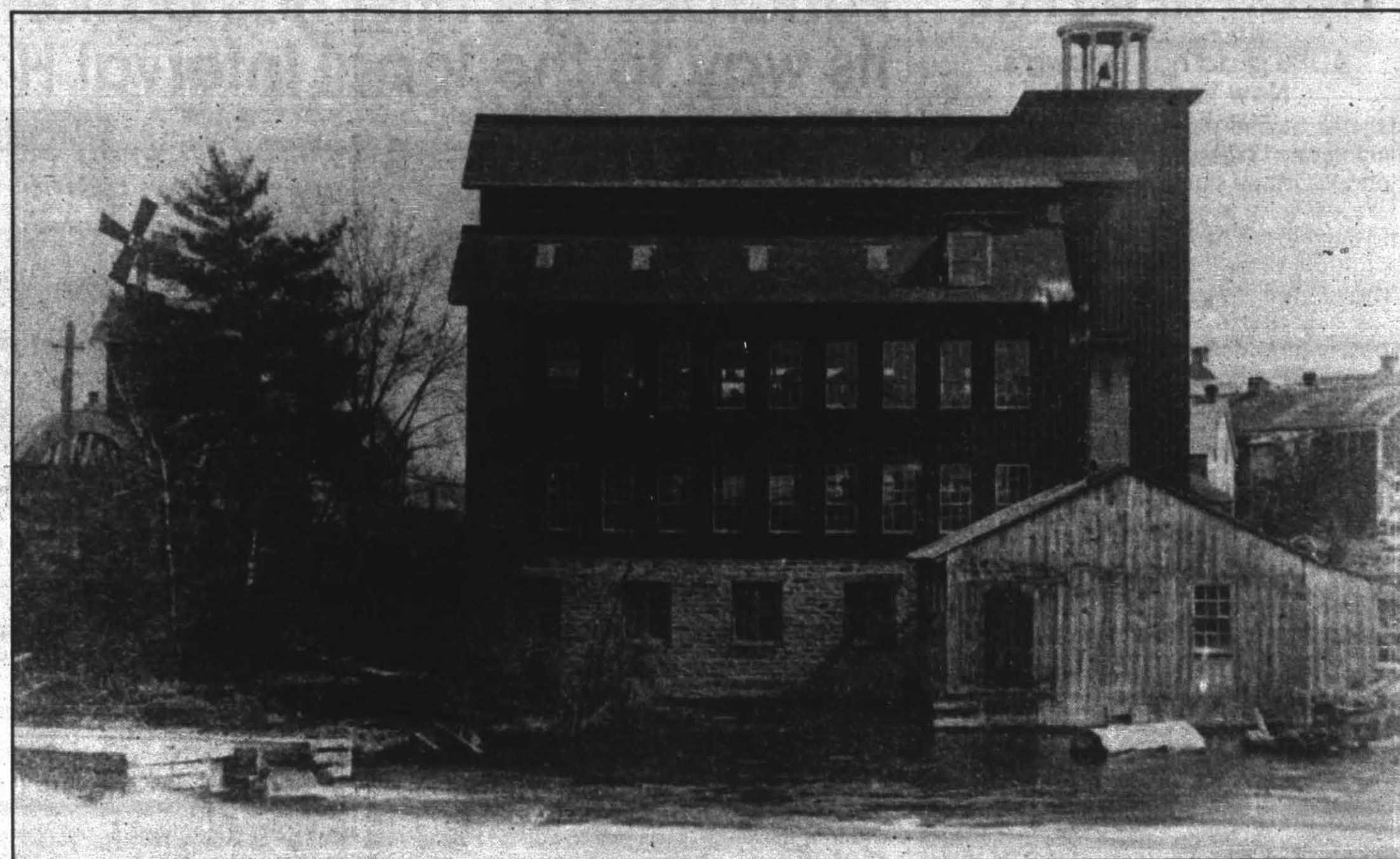
If its general membership agrees, the Almonte Business and Professional Association (ABPA) will merge with the town's Business Improvement Association (BIA) next month.

The 12 members present at last week's regular meeting of the ABPA agreed by motion after over 45 minutes of discussion that it "hereby gives notice to its members that its executive wishes to dissolve on Feb. 5th, 1987, with the aim of merging with the Almonte BIA."

Almonte resident Tony Hickey now has his sights firmly set on becoming the top light heavyweight armwrestler in the world.

And on Jan. 3, the lanky 27-year-old truck driver/mechanic took a big step toward that goal when he was crowned the 1987 Canadian National Light Heavyweight Champion in the 10th annual national competition in Toronto.

## COLUMNS



### Pic of the Past

The Old Red Mill in Almonte was built by Bennett Rosamond in 1882. The mill was used to produce "men's combinations", which translated into long Johns. The factory ceased operating in 1933, and was

demolished in 1934. The mill was located on Mary Street, near the current Millfall condominiums which used to be the Rosamond Woollen Mill.

## All provinces should be 'distinct'

I always wondered what distinct society meant exactly. And even after getting some information on the subject, I'm not sure I fully understand what all the fuss is about.

I do know that the high priest Bouchard is screaming for it, and the last I heard Quebec Liberal leader Daniel Johnson is begging the rest of Canada to endorse the concept in order to keep the country whole.

These facts I am sure of. The rest of Canada has reasonable doubt that a distinct society clause for Quebec will finally satisfy the province. Will declaring Quebec a distinct society in the Constitution only buy us a bit more time? Or will it simply act as a small stop-gap until Quebec comes up with another demand?

I have to ask what is the point of distinct society status for the province of Quebec if there is going to be another referendum to separate? And at the rate the opposers to separation are leaving the province, (the latest count is up in the thousands since the last vote) it doesn't take a mathematician to figure out that the loss of those votes could easily affect the outcome.

### From the Heart

By Mary Cook



Recently, a daily newspaper stated what distinct society could mean. It could mean that Quebec would be recognized in the Constitution as, to put it bluntly, being different.

Well look, every province in Canada has something that is distinctly different. Right from the Rockies of British Columbia to the oil fields of Alberta, to the prairies of Saskatchewan, to the Great Lakes System which touches the borders of Ontario, to the hospitality and warmth that comes out of the Maritimes...we each have our own distinctiveness.

If Canada decides to give Quebec special status, one of the clauses will guarantee Quebec will have three Quebec judges sitting on the Supreme Court of Canada. It doesn't take a genius to figure out that the bench will be a little lop-

sided in favour of Quebec. Does this mean that even after giving Quebec special status, and we are foolish enough to allow this clause to stand, and the province of Quebec then votes for separation, these judges are kicked off the bench?

Just maybe the rest of Canada should play Quebec's game. Perhaps we should say, "fine, we will say Quebec is a distinct society. In other words, we will concede that you are different. We will even say so in the Constitution. But here is the trade-off. There will be no further discussion on separation. There will be no further talk of a referendum to vote the province of Quebec out of Canada. Your province will be treated just like any other province in the country...no special privileges because you are

unique...you will get no more or no less power than the rest of the provinces. The rest of Canada will no longer be obliged to constantly try to woo your province in order to keep the country together. We will let you call yourselves a distinct society if you will agree that every province is distinct in its own way.

Like bribing a child to take his medicine, or to turn out the light at night when it's time to go to bed, we will cater to your childish whim, but only if you agree that you are still part of the family, and any further talk of "leaving home" will find you back where you were before: this time minus your distinct society standing."

In March, the Quebec Liberals hold their convention. Quebec Liberal leader Daniel Johnson will appeal to his party to accept the distinct society clause as part of their position on the constitution. He has said accepting the distinct society clause will cost the other provinces nothing. Pardon? It will only cost the other provinces nothing if they too have the privilege of calling themselves distinct societies as well.

## Mild weather keeps heron, goose here

A lonely great blue heron, in company with a single Canada goose, was noted resting in the afternoon sun along the riverside down river from Carleton Place Dec. 31. Both birds appeared again on Thursday and, as reported by Marion Millar, are still there as this column is being written.

The goose will do all right for food as long as the river doesn't freeze over but the water is too deep for the heron to wade into to find fish. If the goose joins the heron on shore for the night, both will fall prey to marauding foxes. Another heron has been appearing at Dieter and Renate Seiler's pond on Quarry Road.

In a brief summary of bird life in our area during 1996, we have to agree that 1996 was the year of the great gray owl. At least a dozen of these large denizens of the tundra invaded our region in an unprecedented migration southward as food became scarce on home territory. It will be several years before we'll see that kind of invasion again.

Wild turkeys made the news last year as sightings were spread out over the spring, summer and fall. Expect to see more of these huge game birds as re-introduction programs bear fruit. Another game bird, the ring-necked pheasant in Almonte, made the news as the year ended.

When cardinals seemed on a sudden slide at the beginning of last winter, the local birding world responded with a winter survey, indicating all was well; they were just

hiding during the bird count. The same thing seems to have happened again this year.

At least six different bald eagles were spotted over the year, in our area, indicating a possible nesting nearby. On the whole, raptors seemed down in numbers from previous years.

As the year drew to a conclusion, only two northern owls, a hawk owl and a snowy, have been reported, indicating a good supply of food further north.

Voted the bird "most out of its territory" in 1996, the northern gannet, found on Pakenham ski mountain in November, created much interest in birding circles. Sadly, after being caught and cared for at the Wild Bird Care Centre, it suddenly died.

Bird reports this past week include red-breasted nuthatches at the Harvey Cochrane's, Old Union Hall Road in Ramsay, pileated woodpeckers at Jim Benda's home in Darling Township, Al Potvin's at Almonte and Cathy Gordon's, Quarry Road and Drummond Road.

House finches appeared at Allan Staniforth's, Carleton Place area and

a juvenile northern shrike was noted by Carol Baker, West Carleton.

Doug Lewis, in Lanark Township spotted at least six purple finches at their feeders and Maggie Arnott, Carleton Place, had at least 100 goldfinches on Saturday at her feeders and surrounding trees.

Evening grosbeaks are peeking south from the Madawaska Highlands. Three appear regularly at Jim and Yvonne Benda's and Georgina Doe found a small flock right in Carleton Place last week. Contrary to my column last week, there was a flock of 75 evening grosbeaks listed for Beckwith during the bird count.

Margaret Munro, in Clayton, was surprised to find a lonely starling right in her feeder. Cathy Gordon noted a red-tailed hawk perched near their barns and Ron Goodman, Ramsay 12th line, reported a ruffed grouse coming to feed under their feeders. Goodmans also report four or five mourning doves, both white-breasted and red-breasted nuthatches, purple finches and goldfinches and a pileated woodpecker.

### Strictly for the Birds

By Cliff Bennett 256-5013



Only two robins appeared on the recent bird count but several have made their presence known since then. Eleanor Sauve wondered if spring was coming early as one was discovered in a cedar tree near their home in Beckwith. Cathy Gordon heard one singing Dec. 28. Mary Hurdis noted four robins in a tree on Bowland Road south of Clayton on Friday.

The ring-necked pheasant is still around the neighbourhood of the hospital in Almonte, having survived for almost four weeks now. Connie Hodges had been feeding it for a week before New Year's and Pat Donahue observed the bird in his back yard on Saturday. I applaud the neighbourhood's efforts to "look out for" this beautiful game bird.

When does the neighbour's brick chimney become fur-lined? When it is covered with a hundred or so goldfinches, hugging the sides as if trying to give the chimney greater comfort. Gordon Foss in Beckwith, looked across the street and noticed the outside of the chimney coated with goldfinches, on all sides.

Taking his binoculars, he went over to investigate further and found that the birds were pecking at the mortar between the bricks. They were satisfying some craving for grit or salt.

The fact they were only at this one chimney indicates a possible change in the mortar composition, allowing the needed ingredients to seep out. I hope the chimney isn't going to disintegrate. Has anyone else noticed this strange bird behaviour before?

**We want your letters! Let us know what you think, and don't forget to sign your name**